

RAMming Into A Fraud?

Q I recently assembled a PC that comprises an Athlon 2600+ CPU, an Asus A7N8X-VM/400 motherboard and 512 MB of DDR 400 MHz RAM by Hynix. My system is configured to use the onboard graphics card.

Well, I powered the PC on and entered the BIOS. Here, the RAM module is stated to run at 333 MHz, which makes me wonder whether my vendor tricked me into buying faulty stuff. He tells me that it is 400 MHz and is indicated to be 333 MHz, owing to sharing. Yes, there are markings on the Hynix RAM module that indicate its



frequency to be 400 MHz. If so, why is the BIOS screen quoting only 333 MHz?

Lakshmi Narayanan K.

A The Asus A7N8X-VM/400 supports a DDR 400 module only if you install and use a separate video card. That is why the BIOS displays the RAM module to be running at 333 MHz. This is a limitation of the motherboard and has got nothing to do with the clock speeds of the memory chip.

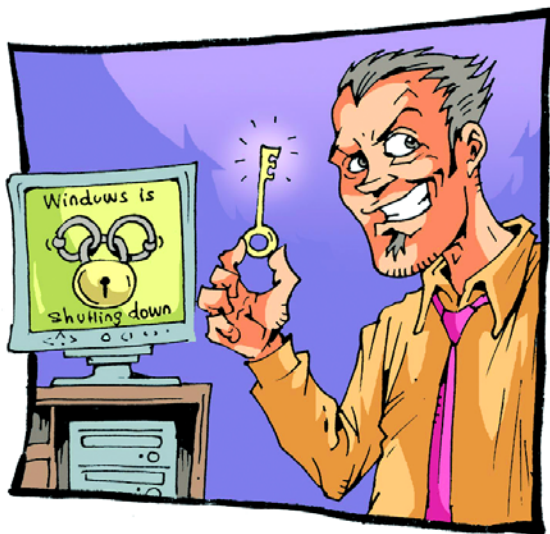
A The 'Choose Recorder' dialog box will only specify whether the drive supports overburning or not. To enable overburning, start Nero Burning ROM and go to File > Preferences. In this window, click on the 'Expert Features' tab and check the 'Enable overburn Disc-at-once burning' option. Click OK and then try overburning a disc.

Shuts Down And Is Infected

Q I have dual-booted my PC with Windows XP and Windows 98. The system does not turn off when working with Windows XP. The 'Shut down' command works fine in Windows 98 though. I repaired it using the repair console on the installation CD but to no avail. Help me fix this problem.

Also, when I connect to the Internet in Windows XP, I receive a message that says 'The system is going to shutdown due to a problem in remote control procedure'. Where do I get the security patch to fix this virus problem?

Sashi Prakash



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatterjee

A Windows XP Service Pack 1 has a patch that addresses improper XP shutdowns. Visit <http://support.microsoft.com/?kbid=307274> for further information.

The virus you are referring to is the Sasser virus, which causes computers running

Windows XP or 2000 to restart every time they connect to the Internet. Download its patch from <http://securityresponse.symantec.com/avcenter/venc/data/w32.sasser.removal.tool.html>. Run this tool after booting into Safe Mode (Hit [Del] or [F8] as you power the system on). That done, download the WindowsXP-KB824146-x86-ENU.exe file from <http://www.microsoft.com/downloads/details.aspx?FamilyId=5F055AE-A1BA-4D4A-B424-95D32CFC8CBA&displaylang=en>.

Run this file and your issue will be resolved. If the problem persists, you will need to install Windows XP Service Pack 1.

Nero's Options

Q Nero gives me two options 'Quick-erase rewritable disc' and 'Full-erase rewritable disc' to erase a CD-RW. What is the difference between the two? Which one is more efficient?

Do I need to format the hard disk frequently? If not, how often do I need to do so?

How do I disable the Autorun feature of my CD-Writer in Windows XP Professional?

Devashish

A 'Quick erase rewritable disc' deletes the files from the CD so they can be recovered by recovery software, while 'Full-erase rewritable disc' formats the CD. As long as you don't keep your confidential data on your CD-RW a quick-erase is fine.

Opt for a format only as the last resort. Usually, you format a hard disk only after you have tried all the necessary PC troubleshooting steps required. If your system is running slow, defragment the hard drive and check it for errors. Use applications such as System Mechanic or Norton Cleansweep to clear any accumulated garbage files.

As for your last query, go to My Computer, right-click your CD-Writer drive, select Properties, go to the AutoPlay tab, choose 'Select an action to perform:' and for every content type, choose 'Take no action'. This will disable the Autorun feature.

TV-out Not Working

Q My Pentium 4 2.4 GHz system has onboard graphics as well as an nVidia chipset AGP